

**AGRICULTURAL PERSONNEL
MANAGEMENT (AGR 402)**

LECTURE NOTE

BY

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MEANING OF PERSONNEL MANAGEMENT:

Personnel Management (staffing function of Management), also known as Human Resource Management. Personnel management is concerned with the proper use of human factors. Personnel management may be defined as that part of the management process, which is primarily concerned with the human constituents of an organization. Personnel management can also be defined as, that field of management which is concerned with the planning, organizing, directing and controlling various operative functions of procurement, development, maintenance and utilization of a labour force in such a way that objectives of company, those of personnel at all levels and those of community are achieved.

FUNCTIONS OF PERSONNEL MANAGEMENT:

Planning

Planning can be defined as forward thinking about courses of action based on a full understanding of all factors involved and directed at specific goals and performance objectives. Let's examine this definition in more detail. The first segment focuses on forward thinking, which means just that, looking ahead. This is not a forecast but an action-oriented statement thinking about the future. To look forward, it is vital to be well aware of the events of world and key trends. The second element concerns courses of action, which implies developing alternatives or methods of accomplishing specific goals and objectives, based on a full understanding of all factors involved. Here is where the facts and consequences of the various factors affecting the alternative courses of action are weighed. Finally, there is the most important part of all, as well as the most neglected: directed at specific goals and objectives, or, in other words, focusing on some end-point, some target.

Types of planning

The planning task represents the preparation of the agribusiness firm for future business conditions. Since the future can be defined to include various time periods and it is uncertain, the planning task can take a number of forms. The three types of planning discussed in this chapter are strategic, tactical, and contingency.

2. Strategic planning is focused on developing courses of action for the longer term. Long term may be two or three years for a very small agribusiness, while a major corporate organization may be looking at a 20-year (or longer) time horizon. Strategic plans tackle the broadest elements of an agribusiness firm's strategy: what countries will we operate in; what businesses will we be in; what plants will we build, what technologies will be developed? While strategic plans are found at all large agribusiness companies, they are also important for the

small food processor or the sales manager for a swine genetics company. It is the long-term time horizon that characterizes the strategic planning activity. Any planning activity is focused on achieving some goal, on moving the firm in some direction. Therefore, in many strategic planning situations, one of the first steps is the development of a mission statement or a statement of vision. A mission statement helps to spell out this direction for a firm and describes the destination. When developing a mission for a company or even for a department, management must think strategically about the firm's business in a future time period. Briefly stated in between one and three sentences, a mission statement usually describes who the company is, what they do, and where they are headed. In many cases, it has three parts: • Key markets (who we serve)

- Contribution (what we do)

- Distinction (how we do it differently)

2. Tactical planning involves short-term plans consistent with the strategic plan. As such, tactical plans are a crucial part of implementing the agribusiness firm's strategic plan. While strategic planning is focused on what we do in three years (or five years, or 20 years), tactical planning is focused on what we do tomorrow (or next month, or next year). For example, a chemical company's strategic plan could include a goal of increasing its market share by 20 percent in three years by using a strategy of expanding its geographic market. The firm's tactical plan may focus on how to increase sales in the next quarter in specific geographic regions that have less competition, and will likely include specific action steps for getting this done.

3. Contingency planning is the development of alternative plans for various possible business conditions. It is part of the strategic and tactical planning process for a firm. A contingency plan provides guidance when something unexpected happens. Some contingency planning is conducted to prepare for potential crises that may occur. For example, a seed company markets varieties specific to the growing conditions of a particular geographic region of the country. However, a prolonged wet period during the planting season would cause the seed company to implement a contingency plan based on delayed planting, which may result in providing an additional supply of short-season varieties. On the other hand, a food company may need a contingency plan for the best-case scenario. What do they do if demand for their new organic frozen entree grows at ten times the initial forecast? How will they handle the extra production and distribution? Thus, both bad and good outcomes can create the need for a contingency plan.

Levels of planning

As the level of planning moves from the chief executive to the line worker, several changes occur. At top management levels, plans are strategic and have a tendency toward flexibility, are longer range, are usually written, are more complex, and are broader in nature. At the lower levels, plans are specific in nature, are for immediate action, are usually unwritten, and tend toward simplicity. Although plans tend to be unwritten at the lower levels, almost all managers benefit from having written plans. Upon writing down a plan, the plan becomes more focused and any inconsistencies or gaps are likely to be made visible. Written plans tend to organize and consolidate thoughts, are easier to communicate, and provide a source for further reference. Depending on the structure of the firm, another reason the nature of planning changes from the top management level to lower levels is the allocation of resources. Top executives develop strategic plans that generally add or subtract resources from the agribusiness, while those plans made at the lower levels are operational and generally relate to using the existing resources in the most efficient manner. The challenge is to help those at all levels of the organization understand the long-range goals and how the short-range performance objectives are intermediate steps for accomplishing those goals.

The planning process

Six steps in the planning process provide structure to the process and are designed to provide management with as much information as is available when developing the strategic or tactical plan. These six steps follow:

1. Gather facts and information that have a bearing on the situation.
2. Analyze what the situation is and what problems are involved.
3. Forecast future developments.
4. Set performance objectives, the benchmarks for achieving strategic goals.
5. Develop alternative courses of action and select those that are most suitable.
6. Develop a means of evaluating progress, and readjust the plan as the process unfolds.

Step 1: Gather facts

Gathering facts and information is the first step of the planning process. Although it should be noted that information gathering is a recurring part of the process. Its place as a first step is easily justified, since adequate information must be available to formulate or synthesize a problem or opportunity. Fact gathering is subdivided into two parts: gathering sufficient information to identify the need for a plan in the first place and systematic gathering of specific facts needed to make the plan work once it has been developed. Two challenges can limit fact gathering. First, some managers tend to skip or minimize this step because of the difficulty of

gathering data. Instead of planning, they resort to a “seat of the pants” or “gut-feel” philosophy, which reduces the likelihood of success. Second, a manager should not become so engrossed in fact gathering that inaction results.

Step 2: Analyze the facts

The groundwork for developing a sound plan is provided during the process of **analyzing facts**. This process answers such questions as “Where are we?” and “How did we get here?” It helps pinpoint existing problems and opportunities, and provides the framework upon which to base successful decisions. An analysis of facts will prevent mistakes and allow for the most efficient use of the organization’s resources.

Step 3: forecast change

Forecasting change is the third key element of good planning. The ability to determine what the future holds may be the highest form of management skill. As managers ascend the organizational ladder, the demands on their abilities in this area steadily increase. Forecasting becomes more difficult as the situation becomes broader, more complex, or for a longer time horizon. Forecasting is interrelated with the other five steps and it is a logical extension of analysis into a future time setting. Some say, “No one can predict the future in our business.”

While no one can be expected to predict accurately all future developments, this is hardly a good reason for not attempting to anticipate what the future might entail. Many failures that occur in forecasting result from sloppy, ambiguous, and generalized thinking. Other failures arise from a poor job of collecting facts. Forecasting change is not a guessing game; it is part of a disciplined approach to planning.

Step 4: Set goals/performance objectives

The development of goals and/or performance objectives is the next step in the planning process. Goals are the specific quantitative or qualitative aims of the company or business group that provide direction and standards one can use to measure performance. Top management, boards of directors, and/or chief executives often develop these goals to help bring focus and specificity to the organization’s mission (see above). The mission statement is the target toward which goals are aimed. In turn, goals are the targets toward which performance objectives are aimed. Well-stated goals should:

1. Provide guides for the performance objectives and results of each unit or person
2. Allow appraisal of the results contributed by each unit or person
3. Contribute to successful overall organizational performance

Performance objectives are then set for specific units and/or individuals. They provide the performance targets at the unit and/or individual levels that are needed to accomplish the

broader, longer-range strategic goals. Performance objectives are usually set for shorter time periods than strategic goals and usually are defined by measurable results. Note that all these processes are going on continuously during the planning process. Performance objectives cannot be set in a vacuum, but must be attainable. Therefore, performance objectives must be a consequence of the gathering and analyzing of relevant information and facts. Some management specialists consider setting goals or performance objectives to be the first step in the planning process. In our discussion of strategic planning above, we started the strategic planning process by developing vision and mission statements. In a way these individuals are correct, but our approach to planning, accumulating, and evaluating information occurs before goal setting is part of the process of setting performance objectives. In practice, many of these steps occur simultaneous. Data may be used to develop an initial set of goals which leads to a need for more data, which requires refining the goals and so on.

Step 5: Develop alternatives

After the performance objectives have been set, agribusiness managers must explore different ways of getting wherever they want to go by developing alternative courses of action. Here again the relationship between performance objectives and results can be seen. The results achieved depend upon the alternative activities selected to meet the objectives. Alternatives must be weighed, evaluated, and tested in the light of the agribusiness' resources. Imagination is crucial since new ways and/or new paths may be the key to success. It is important in this step to be creative, yet practical, in generating alternatives. The conditions surrounding each decision must be carefully considered. For example, a firm might believe that equipping its sales representatives with smart phones and training them in the use of a new database management package might be the best alternative to improve the productivity of the sales force. However, the firm's budget situation may mean that only one-third of the sales representatives can get new phones, or there may be poor wireless coverage in parts of the sales territory. So, the firm may need to look for other (low cost) options to boost sales performance to complement the use of smart phones and new software.

Step 6: Evaluate results

Management specialists have found monitoring progress to be a high priority in planning. Carefully reviewing, assessing, or evaluating results shows whether the plan is on course and allows both the analysis of new information and the discovery of new opportunities. Evaluation cannot be left to chance. It must be incorporated into the planning process, since a plan is only good so long as the situation remains unchanged. An evaluation also reveals whether results met performance objectives or where the results fell short or overshot objectives. Evaluation

also points out weaknesses in plans and programs so that those portions that are ineffective can be changed. In a fast-changing world, continuous evaluation is essential to planning success. Evaluation also triggers the next round of planning.

Organizing

People working effectively towards accomplishing the company's goals; these are objectives of every manager no matter what industry, function, or organization. There must be a structure in place to make it possible for people to work effectively toward accomplishing goals. The management task of organizing provides that structure or framework in which to operate. Organizing represents the systematic classification and grouping of human and other resources in a manner consistent with the firm's goals. The organizing process is important at each level of a company or firm. And, it is the manager's challenge to design an organizational structure that allow employees both to accomplish their own work, while simultaneously reaching the goals and objectives of the organization. The organizing task occurs continuously throughout the life of the firm. Done effectively, this task helps management establish accountability for the results achieved; prevents "buck-passing" and confusion as to who is responsible; and details the nature and degree of authority given to each person as the activities of the firm are accomplished. This task is especially important in today's business environment in which many firms frequently restructure their operations. This restructuring may be the result of efforts to improve efficiency, reduce costs, or as the result of a merger or acquisition. The manager must develop an effective organizational structure before he or she can implement the strategies needed to achieve the goals developed in the planning task. Organizing involves:

- Setting up the organizational structure
- Determining the jobs to be done
- Defining lines of authority and responsibility
- Establishing relationships within the organization

Until all employees understand their relationships to other employees and to the agribusiness as a whole, cooperation, teamwork, and coordinated action remain impossible to achieve. If members of a band fail to understand their connection to the whole, discord rather than harmony will result. Thus, as part of the organizing task, the agribusiness manager must see to it that each employee has a clearly defined role, and that when the employee accomplishes his or her goal, the goals for the organization are furthered.

Directing

Directing is guiding the efforts of others toward achieving a common goal. It is accomplished by:

- Selecting, allocating, and training personnel
- Staffing positions
- Assigning duties and responsibilities
- Establishing the results to be achieved
- Creating the desire for success
- Seeing that the job is done and done properly

Directing involves leading, supervising, motivating, delegating, and evaluating those whom you manage. Managers are directing when they see to it that the efforts of each individual are focused on accomplishing the common goals of the organization. Leading is at the very heart of the management process and is founded on a good organizational plan or structure that provides for responsibility, authority, and evaluation. Life, of creating the conditions that make for interest in the job, vigor of action, imaginative thinking, and continuous teamwork. This goal is one that cannot be reached by magic formulas. Its achievement rests in large measure upon the leadership qualities exhibited by the manager.

Controlling

The controlling task represents the monitoring and evaluation of activities. To evaluate activities, managers should measure performance and compare it against the standards and expectations they set. In essence, the controlling task assesses whether the goals and performance objectives developed within the planning task are achieved. Control in management includes an information system that monitors plans and processes to ensure that they are meeting predetermined goals, and sounds a warning when necessary so that remedial action can be taken. If all people were perfect and their work without flaw, there would be no need for controls. Everything would come out according to plan. But what actually happens may not be what was expected. All people make mistakes; they forget, they fail to take action, they lose their tempers, and they behave, in short, like normal human beings. In addition, even when people do exactly what they are supposed to do, the market, the competition, the weather, the equipment, etc. may not cooperate. Control is complementary to the other three tasks of management. It compensates for the misjudgments, the unexpected, and the impact of change. Proper controls offer the organization the necessary information and time to correct programs and plans that have gone astray. They should also indicate the means of correcting deficiencies. Control requires meaningful information and knowledge, and not that which is outmoded or not germane to meeting organizational goals. Much valuable time can be squandered or wasted by a control program unless a careful check of its real value is made periodically. If the need for control information is not real, frustration, disrespect, and inaccuracy are likely to result.

Employees cannot respect a control program that is misused by management. Management can consume valuable time reviewing useless control data, or it can fail to separate the relevant from the irrelevant, with poor performance as the consequence. All business activities produce results. These results should be matched carefully to well-conceived objectives that aim toward organizational goals. One of the most important purposes of control is to evaluate the progress being made toward organizational goals. A good example of this type of control is found in the budget or forecast comparison. Is one over or under the budget? Are forecasts of sales and expenses in line with predictions? The information or control required in all areas must be based on predetermined, written goals. Only then can the agribusiness manager tell whether the reality matches the plans through which success is sought.

NATURE OF PERSONNEL MANAGEMENT:

1. Personnel management includes the function of employment, development and compensation- These functions are performed primarily by the personnel management in consultation with other departments.
2. Personnel management is an extension to general management. It is concerned with promoting and stimulating competent work force to make their fullest contribution to the concern.
3. Personnel management exists to advise and assist the line managers in personnel matters. Therefore, personnel department is a staff department of an organization.
4. Personnel management lays emphasize on action rather than making lengthy schedules, plans, and work methods. The problems and grievances of people at work can be solved more effectively through rationale personnel policies.
5. It is based on human orientation. It tries to help the workers to develop their potential fully to the concern.
6. It also motivates the employees through its effective incentive plans so that the employees provide fullest co-operation.
7. Personnel management deals with human resources of a concern. In context to human resources, it manages both individual as well as blue-collar workers.

PRINCIPLES OF PERSONNEL MANAGEMENT:

Principles of personnel management help the personnel managers to conduct and direct the policies in a proper way. These principles are:

1. Principle of Maximum Personnel Development: By this principle, the workers are developed to the maximum extent, so that their developed ability, cleverness, productivity and efficiency can be used for the firm's objective.
2. Principle of Scientific Selection: This principle enables to have a right person for the right job.
3. Principle of High Morale: Ideal wage policy should be offered to the workers so that their morale becomes high and they work with interest.
4. Principle of Dignity of Labour: The labour should feel proud of their work.
5. Principle of Team Spirit: Team spirit must be developed in the workers. They should work collectively with collective responsibility, and should have sense of cooperation, unity and mutual trust.
6. Principle of Effective Communication: There must be effective communication between the management and workers otherwise complex problems like mistrust, hatred and ill- will arise which in turn affects the production of the organization.
7. Principle of Joint Management: This creates responsibility in the labour with increasing mutual faith and friendship. This improves the labour relations.
8. Principle of Fair Reward: Labour should be given proper compensation for the work. This develops industrial piece.
9. Principle of Effective Utilization of Human Resources: Personnel management should be developed for the effective use of the human resources. Proper training should be awarded to the personnel for their development.

IMPORTANCE OF PERSONNEL MANAGEMENT:

Personnel management is important for avoiding the following consequences:

1. To hire the wrong person in the job.
2. To experience high turnover
3. To find your people not doing their best
4. To waste time with useless interviews
5. To have some of one's employees think their salaries are unfair and inequitable relative to others in the organization.
6. To allow a lack of training to undermine one's department's effectiveness.
7. To commit any unfair labour practices.

EMPLOYEE TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT

Employee training and development refers to the continued efforts of a company to boost its performance. Even though the terms “training” and “development” are used interchangeably, there are a couple of differences between the two concepts. The differences are related to the scope of their applications. Essentially, a training program comes with very precise and measurable goals such as learning how to perform a particular procedure with accuracy or how to operate a piece of machinery. On the contrary, a developmental program centers on acquiring broader skills that can be applied in a wide range of situations. They include skills such as decision-making, communication. Being able to communicate effectively is one of the most important life skills to learn. Communication is defined as transferring information to produce greater understanding. It can be done vocally (through verbal exchanges), through written media (books, websites, and magazines), visually (using graphs, charts, and maps) or non-verbally, and leadership.

BENEFITS OF EMPLOYEE TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT

Although there are a few drawbacks in investing in employee training, the benefits from such programs outweigh them significantly. The benefits include:

1. Addressing weaknesses

If a company owner evaluates his workforce closely, he is likely to find two or more of his employees lacking certain skills. A training program presents an opportunity to instill the needed skills in the employees. Similarly, a development program helps to expand the knowledge base of all employees. In doing so, company owners are able to bridge any gaps and weak links within their organizations. In such a way, every employee will be in a position to fill in for his colleague and handle any task with efficiency.

2. Improved performance of employees An employee who receives training from time to time is in a better position to improve his work productivity. Thanks to training programs, every employee will be well versed with the safety practices and proper procedures to follow when carrying out basic tasks. A training program also helps in building an employee's confidence since he will gain a better understanding of the industry and the responsibilities of his role.

3. Boosts company profile and reputationAs mentioned earlier, employee training is not just good for the employees but also for the firm. Conducting frequent training and development programs is one way of developing the organization's employer brand, thus making it a prime consideration for the top employees working for competitor firms, as well as graduates. A company that trains its employees will be more attractive to potential new employees, particularly those looking to advance their skills

4. InnovationWhen employees receive consistent training and upskilling, it fosters their creativity. The training programs help employees to be more independent and creative when they encounter challenges in their work.

COMMON TRAINING METHODS FOR EMPLOYEE

Although there are new training techniques emerging every day, several common training approaches have proven highly effective. They include:

1. Orientations

Orientation training is crucial to the success of new recruits. It doesn't matter whether the training is implemented through a handbook, a one-on-one session, or a lecture. What matters is providing new employees with information regarding the firm's background, strategies, Mission Statement. A mission statement defines what line of business a company is in, and why it exists or what purpose it serves. Vision, and objectives. Such training gives new employees an opportunity to familiarize themselves with company policies, rules, and regulations.

2. Lectures

Lectures are particularly efficient when the aim is to provide the same information to a large group at once. In doing so, there is no need for individual training and thus, savings on costs. However, lectures also pose some disadvantages. For one, they center on one-way communication, which leaves little room for feedback. Also, the trainer may find it challenging to assess the level of understanding of the content within a big group.

3. Computer-based Training (CBT)

With this approach, computers and computer-based tutorials are the primary means of communication between the trainer and employees. The programs are structured in such a way that they provide instructional materials while also facilitating the learning process. The core benefit of computer-based training (CBT) is that each employee is given the freedom to learn at their own pace in their most convenient time. It also helps to reduce the total cost that an organization incurs in training its employees. Costs are minimized by reducing the training duration, eliminating the need for instructors, and reducing travel.

Managerial Skills Required in an Organisation

To be an effective manager, it is necessary to possess many skills. Not all managers have all the skills that would make them the most effective manager. As technology advances and grows, the skills that are needed by managers are constantly changing. Different levels of management in the organisational structure also require different types of management skills. Generally, however, managers need to have communication skills, human skills, computer skills, time-management skills, and technical skills.

a. Communication Skills: Communication skills fall into the broad categories of oral and written skills, both of which managers use in many different ways. It is necessary for a manager to orally explain processes and give direction to workers. It is also necessary for managers to give verbal praise to workers. Managers are also expected to conduct meetings and give talks to groups of people.

b. Listening Habit: An important part of the oral communication process is listening. Managers are expected to listen to their supervisors and to their workers. A manager must hear recommendations and complaints on a regular basis and must be willing to follow through on what is heard. A manager who doesn't listen is not a good communicator (Ogunbaneru, 2004).

c. Report Writing Skills: Managers are also expected to write reports, letters, memos, and policy statements. All of these must be written in such a way that the recipient can interpret and understand what is being said. This means that managers must write clearly and concisely. Good writing requires good grammar and composition skills. This is something that can be learned by those aspiring to a management position.

d. Human Skills: Relating to other people is vital in order to be a good manager. Workers come in about every temperament that can be imagined. It takes a manager with the right human skills to manage this variety of workers effectively. Diversity in the workplace is commonplace. The manager must understand different personality types and cultures to be able to supervise these workers. Human skills cannot be learned in a classroom; they are best learned by working with people. Gaining an understanding of personality types can be learned from books, but practice in dealing with diverse groups is the most meaningful preparation.

e. Computer Skills: Technology changes so rapidly that it is often difficult to keep up with the changes. It is necessary for managers to have computer skills in order to keep up with these rapid changes. Many of the processes that occur in offices, manufacturing plants, warehouses, and other work environments depend on computers and thus necessitate managers and workers who can skillfully use the technology. Although computers can cause headaches, at the same time they have simplified many of the tasks that are performed in the workplace (Williams, 1978).

f. Time-Management Skills: Because the typical manager is a very busy person, it is important that time be managed effectively. This requires an understanding of how to allocate time to different projects and activities. A manager's time is often interrupted by telephone calls, problems with workers, meetings, others who just want to visit, and other seemingly uncontrollable factors. It is up to the manager to learn how to manage time so that work can be completed most efficiently. Good time-management skills can be learned, but managers must be willing to prioritize activities, delegate, deal with interruptions, organise work, and perform other acts that will make them better managers.

g. Technical Skills: Technical skills are more closely related to the tasks that are performed by workers and are different from computer skills. A manager must know what the workers who are being supervised are doing on their jobs or it will be difficult for him to provide assistance to them. For example, a manager who is supervising accountant's needs to know the accounting processes; a manager who is supervising a machinist or machine operator must know how to operate the equipment; and a manager who supervises the construction of a home must know the sequence of operations and how to perform them.

EMPLOYEE MOTIVATION

Definition: Employee motivation is defined as the enthusiasm, energy level, commitment and the amount of creativity that an employee brings to the organization on a daily basis. Motivation is derived from the Latin word, “movere” which literally means movement. All the definitions that you would read in books or in dictionary relate to the fact that motivation is behavior and one needs to channelize this behavior in order to achieve desired goals and results. Employee motivation is all about how engaged an employee feels in tandem to the organization’s goals and how empowered he/she feels.

Types of employee motivation

There are two types of motivation, intrinsic and extrinsic. An organization needs to understand for a fact that not employees are clones, they are individuals with different traits. Thus effectively, motivating your employees will need to acquire a deeper understanding of the different types and ways of motivation. With this understanding, you will be able to categorize your employees better and apply the right type of motivation to increase the level of employee engagement and employee satisfaction. Some employees respond better to intrinsic motivation while others may respond better to extrinsic motivation.

Intrinsic motivation

Intrinsic motivation means that an individual is motivated from within. He/she has the desire to perform well at the workplace because the results are in accordance with his/her belief system. An individual’s deep-rooted beliefs are usually the strongest motivational factors. Such individuals show common qualities like acceptance, curiosity, honor, and desire to achieve success. Research has shown that praise increases intrinsic motivation, so does positive employee feedback. But it should all be done in moderation. If you overdo any of these, there are high chances that the individual loses motivation. It is well observed in children and I am using this as an example here if children are over praised for the little things they are expected to do on a daily basis, their motivation level decreases. Now if you are reading this blog, there are good chances you are not a child, although we encourage children to read good content, the purpose of writing this blog is to still focus on adults. So if you are a manager, supervisor or in a leadership role, please be intentional with your feedback or praise. Make sure it is empowering and your employees understand your expectations.

Extrinsic motivation

Extrinsic motivation means an individual's motivation is stimulated by external factors-rewards and recognition. Some people may never be motivated internally and only external motivation would work with them to get the tasks done. Research says extrinsic rewards can sometimes promote the willingness in a person to learn a new skill set. Rewards like bonuses, perks, awards, etc. can motivate people or provide tangible feedback. But you need to be careful with extrinsic rewards too! Too much of anything can be harmful and as a manager or a supervisor, you need to be clear to what extent are you going to motivate your employees to accomplish organizational goals.

Top 10 ways to motivate employees

If you are looking for ways to motivate your employees at work, here are the 5 simple ways of making it work:

1. **Employee motivation surveys:** Use an online survey software or platform to conduct employee motivation surveys. Let them give candid and genuine feedback about their experience, ideas, and suggestions. This will help you identify areas that need your attention.
2. **Employee satisfaction surveys:** Employee satisfaction depends on a ton of factors such as work environment, infrastructure, roles and responsibilities, etc. Conducting employee satisfaction surveys will help Managers understand dissatisfaction factors and act on them. Frequent surveys will help addressing dissatisfaction issues faster.
3. **Job well done- recognize it!** Recognition plays a huge role in increasing the motivation levels of the employees. It helps create a healthy bond between the employer and employees. It not only fulfills our basic need of esteem but also facilitates belonging.
4. **Focus on intrinsic rewards:** It is true some people need rewards to get tasks done, but extrinsic rewards fade very quickly. Focus on motivating your employees from within. Some may even say, "yeah this is all good but we gotta eat and pay rent" ... well, that's

true, for that you compensate your employees well, but make sure you create values for your organization that are long-lasting.

5. **Autonomy not bureaucracy:** Micromanagement is the worst thing you can do as a manager. It is not only time consuming, but also really unwanted. If you have hired people with certain skill set let them do their job, be a facilitator, not a dictator. Human beings value autonomy, give them the freedom to get things done in ways acceptable and see the changes.
6. **Create an amazing work environment:** No, it's not Fussball, or free snacks or a coffee machine. According to a study conducted by Ohio State University, your work environment seriously impacts your mood. So it does make sense to invest in the work environment where people actually spend 60 hours a week. Creating a good atmosphere will motivate your staff. Just go ahead and do it.
7. **Be a visionary:** Lead with vision. Employees need to know their efforts are driving something important. They need to know their destination and more importantly the path that will take them there. If as a leader you lack the vision for your own organization, how do you expect them to own up to your vision? Make a visual reminder of your organization's road map, encourage your employees to add to that. You will be surprised how innovative they can get.
8. **Solicit ideas and suggestions, act on them:** Now that you have conducted surveys, you have received feedback from your employees. Ensure that the ideas, suggestions, grievances that they have put forth will be looked into and addressed in a timely fashion.
9. **Career-pathing:** Having a career growth plan with clearly mentioned roles and responsibilities is crucial to employees. It helps them focus, and direct their efforts to an achievable goal. Make sure that you sit down with every employee and come up with a career plan that is transparent and communicated clearly.
10. **Provide Flexibility:** Not all employees are alike. Some prefer 9-5, others not much; some like coming to work daily, others not much. For some, commuting to work might be long and challenging. Allow some flexibility within reason and your employees will be happy and motivated.

IMPORTANCE OF EMPLOYEE MOTIVATION

According to psychologists, self-realization is a very human thing. It is our basic nature to nurture something and see it flourish, it is applicable to most things we do in our day-to-day

life. This is true for both social and societal spaces. Motivation plays a very important factor in a human's life. Whether it is about improving ourselves or our organization's performance. Motivated employees don't need to be told how to get things done, they take initiatives, are eager to take up additional responsibilities, are innovative and go-getters. Motivated employees ensure:

- There is a positive atmosphere within the organization
- Co-workers are happy and feel safe at work
- Make sure clients are happy
- They always achieve better results than their counterparts

RECRUITMENT AND SELECTION PROCESS

Recruitment and selection is one of the important aspects of human resource planning. Human resource planning ensures that right kind and right quality of employees are employed so as to achieve the organizational goals." According to Dale Yoder, "Recruitment is a process to discover the sources of manpower to meet the requirements of the staffing schedule and to employ effective measures for attracting that manpower in adequate numbers to facilitate effective selection of an efficient working force." The process of searching suitable candidates and attracting them to apply for the vacancies in the organization is termed as recruitment. It is the first step for selection and appointment of right employees for the organization.

Recruitment helps in creating a pool of suitable and interested job applicants, out of which few are chosen for the further selection process. Hence, it forms a base for selection process. If the recruitment process is carried out properly, it will help in employing workforce that suits the organizational requirements. Selection of candidates begins where their recruitment ends. In other words, it is only after an adequate number of applications have been secured through different sources of recruitment – internal or external that the process of selection begins. Selection involved a careful screening and testing of candidates who have put in their applications for a job in the enterprise. The enterprise has to choose the best and the most promising persons from among the applicants. In this sense, it may be said that while recruitment is a positive function in that it seeks to induce as many persons as possible to apply for a job in the enterprise. Selection is negative function because it aims at eliminating those applicants who are not found suitable in one respect or the other.

The various process involved are:

1. Application Form:

The application form is designed to contain detailed information about the candidates. It also helps in comparing the merits of the applicants.

The information required in the application form will include some or all of the following:

- (i) Post applied for.
- (ii) Personal data – name, address, telephone number, age, sex, marital status, children, nationality, next of kin.
- (iii) Education – school, college and university attended, degree/ diploma passed, year of passing, subjects offered, grade or division obtained.
- (iv) Professional qualification(s).
- (v) Languages known- ability to read, write and speak.
- (vi) Employment history of all jobs since leaving college/ university, dates from and to, employer's name, address and nature of business, position and duties held, reasons for leaving.
- (vii) Personal circumstances; when required, prepared to serve anywhere or not, etc.
- (viii) Medical history; brief details of any serious illness, disability, major operation, etc.
- (ix) Interest, hobbies, sports and other activities.
- (x) Anything else which an applicant may like to add.
- (xi) References

Space for the candidate's signature, date and place and for office use is given at the end. The printed forms generally contain too much printed matter leaving little space for the applicant to fill in his particulars. There should be at least four times as much space to write in the form as is covered by the print. Some companies have forms printed in different colours

for different categories of posts. This facilitates the sorting out and handling of applications by the concerned officials.

2. Interview:

An interview is the first face to face interaction between the candidate and the company representatives. It is a sine qua non for applicants who qualify in the first screening as probable ones having all the basic requirements. The objectives of selection interviews are to elicit information about the candidate's motives and behaviour, to assess personality, to check the factual information already given by him and to inform him about the job and the company.

The interview may be held either in two stages – preliminary and final – or in one stage only. A preliminary interview could help in recruiting the most probable candidates who could be called for the final interview. It must be conducted by skilled interviewers; otherwise some potential candidates may be lost.

In some cases companies organize successive interviews, i.e. the same candidate is interviewed by one or more interviewers separately one after another. The panel or the board interviews are, however, more common. The panel may consist of a small number of experts while a board may have a larger number. The interview may be patterned or open. In a patterned interview a set of questions is already prepared. The interviewers are able to collect information about the candidate in a systematic and uniform manner. The candidate's basic characteristics and motivations should also be probed into by the interviewers to arrive at a judgement. In a non-patterned or open interview, interviewers put such questions as they feel would make the candidate reveal his mind and his strong and weak points.

For recruiting technical and highly skilled personnel, technical interviews may be arranged to assess the competence of the candidates in their own special fields. The technical expert on the selection board should properly assess the candidate's strengths and weaknesses. If he gives his judgement in such terms as a 'nice chap', or 'got rattled easily', or a 'bit glib', he does not take his job seriously.

Each candidate may be interviewed separately or a number of candidates may be interviewed in a group. Personal interview exposes the candidate only before the board, but group interview exposes him before the other applicants also. In a group interview, a candidate

must get an opportunity to show his initiative and leadership qualities better than in a personal interview.

The interview aims at selecting the best out of the most probable candidates. It must be conducted in an objective manner. The interviewers should not permit their personal likes and dislikes and prejudices to come in the way of proper assessment of the candidates. They should not allow the filtering of information about the candidate through their own 'subjective screen of views, needs and prejudices'. They are supposed to pay the same degree of attention to all the candidates on similar aspects of performance.

The very often committed errors by interviewers are:

- i. The halo error- giving high rating to the candidates whose liking and disliking seem similar to his own
- ii. The logical error- judging on a wrong yardstick
- iii. The errors of leniency- helping to come out for something which the candidate cannot cope with
- iv. The contrast error- penalizing the candidate for having opposite ideas or preferences.

The interviewer should keep an open mind till the end of the interview. Too much warming up to the candidate should also be avoided. The candidates should be given an opportunity to talk in a free atmosphere. There should be minimum stress in the beginning so that the candidate does not feel nervous. The room where the interview is conducted should be free from interruptions of telephone calls or visitors.

The assessment of the interviews should be recorded immediately after the interviews are over. All members of the board/panel should give their rating on a defined scale such as- A = Outstanding, B = Good, C = Average and D = Poor. Final selection should be made on the basis of consensus as far as possible after discussing the relative merits and demerits of potential candidates who are on the top of the list.

3. Employment Tests:

As a method of selection, the employment tests are an exception rather than the rule. They may be used to supplement the information already collected through the application forms and interviews. The future performance of the candidate in a particular field may be predicted to some extent by the tests specially designed for the purpose. The disappointment which arises from failures and dropouts in training and later on the job can be avoided by the use of the tests of ability and potential of applicants.

The five main groups of psychological tests are:

I. Intelligence tests:

Intelligence tests are particularly useful in selecting candidates for jobs which call for problem solving abilities or which involve extensive training. Different forms of intelligence tests are used for candidates of different age groups.

II. Attainment tests:

Attainment tests measure the degree to which a person has acquired knowledge or skill. Tests of knowledge have been developed for spelling, vocabulary, arithmetic, mechanical information and a range of more specialised subjects.

III. Aptitude tests:

Aptitude tests identify an individual's innate suitability for particular types of work and can indicate whether a man would be more suited to one type of work rather than another. Tests of 'sales aptitude', 'managerial aptitude', 'mechanical aptitude', etc. are used to identify the candidate's potentialities in a chosen area. The General Aptitude Test Battery identifies a candidate's abilities in such areas as verbal comprehension, numerical ability, motor coordination, manual dexterity, general intelligence, etc.

IV. Interest tests:

Interest tests help in predicting the areas in which the candidates are most likely to settle down and be satisfied. The candidate's preference for indoor or outdoor jobs, routine or creative work and individual or group responsibilities may be ascertained by administering interest tests.

V. Personality tests:

Personality tests are designed to measure the degree to which an individual possesses such qualities as drive/ persuasiveness, self-confidence, stability, etc. The most promising kind of test to throw light on the personality area is the situational test, e.g. the leaderless group discussion.

The psychological tests have some limitations. The predictions based upon these tests cannot be hundred percent correct. Further, the candidates brought up in poor families, and in the rural and backward regions may be put to a disadvantage as compared to those coming from affluent urban families when these tests are used as a primary measure for judging their abilities, levels of maturity, etc. The tests should be properly designed and administered by the experts. They should be used to supplement other methods.

4. References:

References should be sought, after the selection is finalised. These may be either in a written form or checked over the telephone. If references are sought before the interview, they may bias the thinking of the members of the selection board. The opinions of the previous employers and other persons referred to by the candidate are only as reliable as the judgement of the person giving them. References may help in checking certain facts given by the candidate in the application form.

5. Medical Test:

The selected candidates are medically examined by the company's doctor or approved medical practitioners. Medical tests may vary from the comprehensive to the nominal, depending upon the nature of the job. The manual jobs may require comprehensive medical tests to prevent infection, detect ailments and complicated diseases.

6. Appointment Order:

The selected candidates are issued letters of appointment after the recommendations of the selection board are approved by competent authority in the company. Appointments at senior positions such as the chief executives, general managers, financial advisors, etc. need the

approval of the board of directors. The chief executive may be the approving authority in the case of other posts.

An appointment order states the post offered, salary and perquisites, service conditions, duration of the post (permanent, temporary, contractual), reporting authority, time limit for communicating acceptance and joining the post, etc. It is duly signed by the employing authority and becomes the first basis of contractual relationship between the company and the candidate.